

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 17 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 19 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A strong high pressure system south of the state will maintain a ridge across SA for the next few days as it drifts eastwards, to be located over NSW from Friday. A cold front is then likely to approach from the west late Saturday and move across SA on Sunday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres around midday. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre during the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore early in the morning. Winds tending northeasterly in the morning then tending northeast to southeasterly in the middle of the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northerly in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre during the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots tending northeasterly in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, decreasing below 0.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots inshore in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning northeasterly in the early morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late morning and afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming northerly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning northwesterly in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northwesterly during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Sunny.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming west to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending north to northwesterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to below 1 metre south of Beachport. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Strong Wind Warning for Friday for Lower South East Coast

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 30 knots south of Beachport in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 25 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Port MacDonnell. Swell: West to southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly in the early morning then decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.